

HOUSE BILL 643

By Carringer

AN ACT to amend Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 63,
Chapter 5 and Title 68, relative to dental services.

BE IT ENACTED BY THE GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE:

SECTION 1. Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 68, Chapter 1, Part 3, is amended by adding the following as a new section:

(a) The commissioner of health shall create programs designed to enhance access to dental services in rural and underserved areas. The programs may include cooperative agreements with dental schools, enhancements and upgrades to departmental clinic sites, provider incentive programs, restorative and other specialty dental services, programs supporting dental care for seniors, training opportunities for providers, and support for high technology and telecommunications efforts.

(b) All programs created by the commissioner of health pursuant to subsection (a) are subject to the approval of the commissioner of finance and administration.

SECTION 2. This act is not an appropriation of funds, and funds shall not be obligated or expended pursuant to this act unless the funds are specifically appropriated by the general appropriations act.

SECTION 3. This act takes effect upon becoming a law, the public welfare requiring it.